
Which prompt is worth polishing first?
A
Daily support summary
Estimated time saved/month:
100 minutes
B
Weekly meeting recap
Estimated time saved/month:
40 minutes
C
Quarterly report outline
Estimated time saved/month:
30 minutes

What problem are we solving?

3 hours: 50-minute lesson, 10-minute break, 50-minute guided practice, 10-minute break, 50-minute applied practice, and 10-minute wrap-up.

SITUATION

The problem

A student has several prompts but limited time to polish and present them. Choosing by novelty alone can overlook a simple prompt that solves a frequent task.

TARGET

Learning goal

Compare candidate prompts using practical value, reuse, output quality, and a modest time-saved estimate.

Practice material: Use the practice material supplied in the session Markdown.

Use these supplied facts

Do not replace missing information with guesses.

CASE MATERIAL

Practice candidates (fictional estimates)

- A: format a daily 10-minute support summary, used 20 times/month; B: draft a weekly 20-minute meeting recap, used 4 times/month; C: outline a quarterly 60-minute report, used once/month. Estimate each saves half the original time: A saves 5 minutes/use, B 10, C 30.

BOUNDARY

Use the supplied facts

A student has several prompts but limited time to polish and present them. Choosing by novelty alone can overlook a simple prompt that solves a frequent task.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Calculate an estimate before ranking

- Estimated monthly time saved equals minutes saved per use multiplied by monthly uses. From the fictional candidates, A is 5 x 20 = 100 minutes, B is 10 x 4 = 40 minutes, and C is 30 x 1 = 30 minutes. These are estimates based on the exercise assumption that each prompt saves half the original time, not measured or guaranteed savings.

LEARN

Compare value and risk, not just a large number

- A prompt used often may be more useful than a dramatic one-off task. Consider usefulness, repeat frequency, consistent output, ease of reuse, and the cost of an error. A high estimated time saving does not make a prompt safe or accurate. Score candidates with the same criteria so the comparison is fair.

Understand the idea and apply it

Work through the explanation before comparing prompts or starting the exercise.

LEARN

Test the leading prompt on fresh input

- Choose one prompt to polish, then ask a partner to run it with a new input. Record one quality issue and whether the prompt handled the new case. Explain one reason not to choose each alternative. Do not convert saved minutes into a money claim unless a separate, supported cost calculation is available.

APPLY

Three-step method

- Estimate time saved; score prompts against shared criteria; select one to improve and explain the trade-off.

What makes a prompt weak?

These examples come from the current session scenario.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Which prompt is the coolest?

Message AI...

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Pick the highest-scoring one and say it will save money.

Message AI...

A clearer, safer prompt

Keep the source, task, constraints, and output check visible.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

For each candidate, calculate estimated minutes saved per month from the figures below.
Show the multiplication and label results as estimates.

Message AI...

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Compare the three prompts on usefulness, repeat frequency, consistency,
ease of reuse, and error risk (low/medium/high). Recommend one to polish first
and state one reason not to choose each alternative. Do not claim measured savings.

Message AI...

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Exercise 1: Follow the steps

- Calculate A = 100 minutes/month, B = 40, C = 30. Score each from 1-3 on usefulness and ease of reuse; add an error-risk note. Discuss why estimated time alone is not the whole decision.

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

Use the complete case and instructions from the session Markdown.

APPLIED PRACTICE

Exercise 2: Try a small variation

- Bring two prompts from earlier sessions. Have a partner test each with a new input, record one quality issue, and choose which prompt is most ready to document.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W15_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- Introduction: Explain why choosing a prompt by novelty alone can be a mistake.
- Method: Copy the two prompts you brought from earlier sessions.
- Results: Include the comparison table with time-saved calculations, scores, error-risk notes, and the quality issue your partner found.
- Conclusion: Give a short recommendation with one caveat.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- The time calculations are correct, estimates are labeled, and the recommendation considers quality and risk as well as frequency.